

Northwind Information Security Policy (Fictional)

Purpose

This fictional policy outlines baseline security practices that all Northwind employees must follow to protect company and customer data.

Password Requirements

All accounts must use strong, unique passwords managed through the approved password manager.

- Minimum 12 characters, including upper/lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols
- No password reuse across the last 10 passwords
- Multi-factor authentication required for all business systems
- Passwords must be changed immediately if compromise is suspected

Device Security

Company laptops must have disk encryption and endpoint protection software enabled at all times. Personal devices used for work (BYOD) must be enrolled in the mobile device management (MDM) system before accessing company email.

Data Classification

Company data is classified into three tiers, each with different handling requirements.

- Public — may be shared externally without restriction
- Internal — for employee use only, not for external distribution
- Confidential — customer data, financial records, and trade secrets; requires encryption in transit and at rest

Incident Reporting

Suspected security incidents, including phishing emails, lost devices, or unauthorized access, must be reported to security@northwind-example.com within 24 hours of discovery.

Acceptable Use

Company systems are provided for business use. Limited personal use is permitted as long as it does not interfere with work duties or violate other Northwind policies.